

Shapes and sizes



Japanese maple



Himalayan birch



Fig



Acacia



Horse chestnut

Drip-dry

Life in a tropical forest is hot and damp and there is no shortage of water. Monstera leaves have a special waxy surface, so the water can run off.

Monstera plants grow in the shade of trees that constantly drip moisture.



Prickly customers

Plants can't run away from hungry animals, so they have to protect themselves. Prickly holly gets left alone!

Tough, glossy leaves are a good defense against wind and weather.



Shady character

The maidenhair fern lives in damp, shady places, where its fragile leaves won't dry out in the sun.



Water signals

Leaves can't talk, but they can sometimes send a message. The leaves of this cyclamen are limp and drooping as if the plant is unhappy. The soil in the pot is dry, and the message is, "Water me."



Do plants sweat?

Plants are constantly losing water through their leaves as part of a process called transpiration. Most of the time you can't see it happening. But if you put a plant inside a plastic bag and tie it, after a while you will see waterdrops on the inside of the bag. The moisture you can see is coming from the leaves of the plant.

